Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Frequently Asked Questions — For Customers & IT Administrators

Licensing & Access

Q1. Is a separate Viva Insights licence needed if we already have Microsoft 365 Copilot?

No. Every M365 Copilot licence automatically includes the Viva Insights service plan — covering personal insights, manager/leader insights, and advanced analysis. A separate Viva Insights purchase is only needed if you want to analyse employees who do *not* have Copilot licences.

Q2. Who needs licences — only leaders viewing dashboards, or also the employees whose data we want to analyse?

Both. Employees whose collaboration data you want to analyse must have a Viva Insights licence assigned (included with every Copilot licence). Leaders and managers viewing dashboards also need a Viva Insights licence to access the full Copilot Dashboard and organisation insights. Unlicensed employees who collaborate with licensed users appear as "other internal collaborators" in aggregate but are not directly measured.

Q3. What is the minimum number of licences needed for full dashboard features?

With **1+ assigned Copilot licences**, you get the Readiness, Adoption, and Impact pages with tenant-level and group-level metrics and HR filters. With **50+ Copilot or Viva Insights licences** (or a combination), you additionally get agent-related insights (Agent Dashboard), benchmarks, intelligent summaries, sentiment survey metrics, trendlines, manager group-level views with delegation, and the “All” licence type view.

Q4. What happens if we drop below 50 licences?

The core dashboard (Readiness, Adoption, Impact with group-level metrics) remains available with 1+ Copilot licences. Dropping below 50 disables advanced features: Agent Dashboard, benchmarks, intelligent summaries, sentiment survey metrics, trendlines, manager delegation, and the “All” licence type view. Previously available data is retained.

Q5. Can we trial the Dashboard before licensing everyone?

> Yes. The Copilot Dashboard is available to any M365/O365 tenant with Exchange Online. With even 1 assigned Copilot licence, you get Readiness, Adoption, and Impact pages with group-level metrics. Advanced features (benchmarks, Agent Dashboard, sentiment, delegation) require 50+ Copilot or Viva Insights licences.

Privacy & Data Protection

> ### Q6. Can managers see individual employee Copilot usage?
>
> **No.** All data is aggregated at group level and protected by minimum group size thresholds (default 10, minimum 5), differential privacy, and distribution masking. No individual user behaviour is ever visible in the dashboards.

> ### Q7. Can employees opt out of being analysed?
>
> Users can opt out of Viva Insights personal insights via their settings. For advanced analysis and the Copilot Dashboard, the Insights Administrator can configure privacy settings and create exclusion lists to remove specific users from aggregated insights.

> ### Q8. What is the minimum group size, and can we change it?
>
> The minimum group size is the smallest number of people for which data will be displayed. Default is **10**; the lowest allowed setting is **5**. It can be configured by the AI Administrator or Insights Administrator. Groups smaller than this threshold will show "N/A" instead of data.

Data & Reporting

> ### Q9. How often does the data refresh?
>
> The Copilot Dashboard refreshes **daily**, showing a 28-day rolling window with up to a 6-day delay from the current date. Admin Center reports refresh approximately every 72 hours. Newly licensed employees may take an additional 7 days before appearing.

> ### Q10. Can we see data by business unit, department, or country?
>
> **Yes**, but you must upload organizational data (a CSV file with attributes like Business Unit, Department, Country) to enable these filters. Without an org data upload, only the Entra ID "Department" field is available as a filter. Custom attributes can also be added.

> ### Q11. Does the Dashboard track Copilot Chat (web) usage?

> **For paid Copilot users: Yes.** If Copilot Chat reporting is enabled in your tenant, there is a separate licence filter on the dashboard to switch between Microsoft 365 Copilot and Copilot Chat views — available with 1+ Copilot licences. **For free Copilot Chat users (E3/E5 without Copilot add-on): Yes, with limits.** The Copilot Dashboard includes a **Copilot Chat** licence filter that shows insights for active users of the free Copilot Chat app. Free users are *not* tracked by Viva Insights custom queries or Admin Center Copilot usage reports. To understand free Copilot Chat adoption beyond the dashboard (e.g., building a business case for paid licences), consider M365 Audit Logs (Purview) as a complementary analytics workstream.

> **Q12. How is the $72/hour default for Copilot Assisted Value calculated?**
>
> The $72/hour is based on data compiled by the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics as a broad estimate of loaded labour cost. **Customers should adjust this to their own loaded rate** for accurate ROI calculations. The rate can be changed in the Impact settings or via the Hours and Value calculator on the dashboard.

Agent Dashboard

> **Q13. Can we use the Agent Dashboard without the Copilot Dashboard?**
>
> Both are part of the Viva Insights web app. You cannot enable one without the other being available, but access to each can be controlled separately via Viva Feature Access Management (VFAM) policies.

> **Q14. Why can my delegates see the Copilot Dashboard but not the Agent Dashboard?**
>
> Managers cannot access a team-level view in the Agent Dashboard. Delegates must be given **"Your company"** scope (not "Your group") to access the Agent Dashboard. Update their delegation scope in Viva Insights → Settings → Delegation.

Scope & Broader Productivity

> **Q15. We want broader productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time, after-hours) — not just Copilot reporting. Is that available?**
>
> **Yes, but through a separate workstream.** Copilot Analytics covers Copilot-specific adoption, impact, and ROI. Broader Viva Insights productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time, after-hours, collaboration networks) use the same Viva Insights licence and analyst role but are configured through the Advanced Analysis workbench with different queries and templates. The organizational data and privacy settings you configure for Copilot Analytics carry over to the broader Viva Insights analysis.

Organizational Data

Q16. Do I need to manually prepare and upload a CSV if we use SAP SuccessFactors or Workday?

No. Microsoft provides native HRIS connectors for both SAP SuccessFactors and Workday (Workday limited to ≤100K users). These connectors pull employee data directly from your HRIS on a weekly or monthly schedule — no CSV preparation needed. Configure them in the M365 Admin Center under **Organizational Data in Microsoft 365**. For Workday organisations with >100K users, use the Workday RaaS → Azure Blob Storage path instead.

Q17. Can I automate organizational data uploads instead of manually uploading a CSV every month?

Yes — multiple options exist: (1) **HRIS connectors** (SAP SuccessFactors, Workday) auto-sync on a schedule. (2) **Azure Blob Storage connector** — drop a CSV into an Azure blob and it's picked up automatically. (3) **API-based import** (preview) — push data via REST API using a PowerShell script, C# solution, or Azure Data Factory pipeline. Microsoft provides sample code at github.com/microsoft/orgdata_apibasedimport. The API-based approach also supports **incremental refresh** — you can add new hires without re-uploading all employees.

Dashboard Interpretation

Q18. Why does "View by: Group" show only one person's name instead of sub-groups?

The Group view uses the uploaded manager hierarchy. If most employees report directly to the top-level leader in the org data (flat hierarchy), the dashboard cannot split into sub-groups. **Fix:** Ensure intermediate managers (VPs, Directors) exist as rows in your data file with correct `ManagerEmail` chains. Every `ManagerEmail` value must match a `PersonEmail` in the same file. Also check the Data Quality page — if the manager tree count is in the thousands (e.g., 3,000 trees for 1,000 employees), most hierarchy chains are broken.

Q19. What's the difference between "Copilot Chat (work)" and "Copilot Chat (web)" on the dashboard?

Copilot Chat (work) uses tenant data (SharePoint, Graph) for grounding — it's the work-connected experience. **Copilot Chat (web)** uses web data only — no work context. Both appear as **separate rows** in the Adoption by App table. Both require an M365 Copilot licence to be tracked. E3/E5 users without the Copilot add-on who use copilot.microsoft.com are **not tracked** by either row.

Q20. The dashboard shows a yellow banner about email data being under-reported. What does this mean?

Microsoft has acknowledged that email draft and summarize email thread metrics were under-reported from **June 1, 2025 through February 18, 2026**. This affects Outlook adoption numbers and email-related Assisted Hours for that period. A separate meeting underreporting issue affected **September 6 through November 3, 2025**. No customer action is needed — the data auto-corrects for periods after the affected windows.

New Features (April 2026)

Q27. What are intent patterns in the Copilot Dashboard?

Intent patterns (public preview, April 2026) categorise Copilot Chat (work) prompts into: **Ask and find** (questions, info retrieval), **Catch up** (summaries, recaps), **Draft and brainstorm** (content creation), and **Other**. Available on the Adoption page and in Viva Insights advanced reporting. These help you understand *how* people use Copilot, not just how much.

Q28. Can I export Copilot Dashboard data for offline analysis?

Yes. The Dashboard now supports a CSV export of de-identified, weekly metrics covering 6 months. Select **Export** on the dashboard. Data matches the on-screen view — aggregated, de-identified, and subject to privacy thresholds. For user-level exports, use Advanced Analytics person queries.

Q29. How can we use Organizational Messages to drive Copilot adoption?

Organizational Messages (GA, April 2026) enable IT admins to send targeted Copilot adoption nudges via email, Teams, or Windows. The key feature is **usage-based targeting** — messages target users based on actual Copilot usage behaviour (never used, tried once, occasional, regular). Configure at `admin.microsoft.com` → Organizational messages.

Q30. Does Microsoft Purview DLP affect Copilot analytics?

Potentially. DLP policies for Copilot (GA) can block prompts containing sensitive information types. Blocked prompts are **not counted** as Copilot actions. If DLP blocks many prompts, usage metrics may appear lower than expected. Coordinate with your Security team to understand DLP impact on analytics. DLP is configured in the Purview Compliance Portal — see aka.ms/Copilot/SecureGovern.

Common Misconceptions

Q21. Copilot data is only available in the global partition, not in individual partitions — true?

Incorrect. The interactive **Copilot Dashboard** is tenant-level only and not partition-scoped. However, all 100+ Copilot metrics (adoption, impact, assisted hours, per-app actions) **are** available in individual partitions via custom person queries and Power BI template queries. Partitioned analysts get scoped Copilot data — they just access it through the analyst workbench, not the Dashboard.

Q22. Can I use Power BI to bypass the minimum group size and see data for small teams?

No. Power BI template reports from Viva Insights enforce the same minimum group size threshold as the Dashboard. The privacy control is applied at the data aggregation layer, not the UI layer. Moving to Power BI does not circumvent it. For finer granularity, you can export raw query results as CSV and build custom PBI visuals — but you are then responsible for enforcing privacy thresholds per your organisation's data handling policy.

Q23. Security groups can't be used for dashboard access — I can only add individuals?

Incorrect. Microsoft Learn confirms that dashboard access supports **Entra security groups, Microsoft 365 groups, and mail-enabled security groups**. If group-based access doesn't work, check: (a) all group members have a Viva Insights service plan, (b) the group is one of the supported types (not a distribution-only group), (c) 24 hours have elapsed since assignment. See Learn reference.

Q24. Published reports can only be shared with individual users, not groups?

Partially incorrect. For built-in Viva Insights PBI reports, "Unfiltered" targets dashboard-access holders and "Filtered" targets enabled managers — these are predefined audiences. However, for **custom report publishing**, you can target **specific users or groups** (security groups and mail-enabled security groups are supported). See Learn reference.

Q25. On-premises Active Directory extension attributes automatically flow to Viva Insights through Entra sync?

No. Only three attributes from Entra ID sync to Viva Insights: PersonId (UPN), ManagerId, and Organization (from the Department field). Extension attributes (extensionAttribute1-15), Company, Division, JobTitle, City, and Country are **not synced** — even if they are populated in Entra via AD Connect. To use these attributes in Viva Insights, upload them via CSV or configure an HRIS connector.

Q26. CSV upload is the only way to get organizational data into Viva Insights — true?

Incorrect. As of 2026, there are **six ways** to ingest organizational data: (1) Entra ID (automatic, default), (2) CSV upload via M365 Admin Center, (3) SAP SuccessFactors native connector, (4) Workday native connector, (5) Azure Blob Storage connector, and (6) API-based import (preview). For details, see Organizational Data in

> Microsoft 365. Microsoft is also migrating all tenants to the M365 Admin Center as the single upload point by mid-2026, replacing the Viva Insights web app upload path.

> **Learn more:** For the full list of Copilot Analytics capabilities and setup steps, refer to the *Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics Implementation Guide* or the following Microsoft Learn resources:
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> - Copilot Analytics Introduction
> - Copilot Dashboard
> - Copilot Analytics Reports
> - Agent Dashboard
> - Licensing & Environment Requirements